

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: July 07,2020

Report Number: JA2020-0141

Report Name: New GI Protections Proposed for EU Agricultural Products

Country: Japan

Post: Tokyo

Report Category: Agricultural Situation, Dairy and Products, Oilseeds and Products, Livestock and Products

Prepared By: Daisuke Sasatani

Approved By: Zeke Spears

Report Highlights:

On July 7, 2020, Japan's Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF) published a list of 21 proposed geographical indications (GIs) for agricultural products from the European Union (EU). The list includes cheeses, ham, olive oil, honey, sausage, butter, baked goods, jam, and an essential oil. MAFF will hold a public comment period for the proposed GI designations through October 7, 2020.

General Information

On July 7, 2020, Japan's Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries (MAFF) published a [list](#) of 21 newly proposed geographical indications (GIs) for agricultural products from the European Union (EU). The products include 5 types of cheese, 5 types of ham, 3 types of olive oil, 2 types of honey, 2 types of sausage, 1 type of butter, 1 baked good, 1 type of jam, and 1 type of essential oil (Table 1). MAFF is holding a public comment period for the proposed GI designations through October 7, 2020. Once the comment period is completed, MAFF will hold an expert committee meeting and then make a final decision on the designation of GIs for the products.

Table 1: EU Proposed 21 Agricultural Products for GI Protection

ID	Country	Name of Product	Type of Product	MAFF Category
72	Austria	Vorarlberger Bergkäse	Natural Cheese	6: Livestock Product
73	Bulgaria	Bulgarsko rozovo maslo	Rose Oil	19: Essential Oil
74	Bulgaria	Strandzhanski manov med / Manov med ot Strandzha	Honey	8: Seasoning
75	Croatia	Baranjski kulen	Sausage	6: Livestock Product
76	Croatia	Drniški pršut	Ham	6: Livestock Product
77	Croatia	Međimursko meso 'z tiblice	Ham	6: Livestock Product
78	Croatia	Slavonski med	Honey	8: Seasoning
79	Croatia	Dalmatinski pršut	Ham	6: Livestock Product
80	France	Beurre Charentes-Poitou / Beurre des Charentes / Beurre des Deux-Sèvres	Butter	9: Oil and Fat Product
81	France	Laguirole	Natural Cheese	6: Livestock Product
82	Germany	Aachener Printen	Baked Goods	10: Bread and Snack
83	Greece	Kefalograviera	Natural Cheese	6: Livestock Product
84	Greece	Kasseri	Natural Cheese	6: Livestock Product
85	Greece	Kalamata	Olive Oil	9: Oil and Fat Product
86	Italy	Toscano	Olive Oil	9: Oil and Fat Product
87	Italy	Culatello di Zibello	Ham	6: Livestock Product
88	Romania	Magiun de prune Topoloveni	Jam	5: Processed Ag Product
89	Romania	Salam de Sibiu	Ham	6: Livestock Product
90	Romania	Telemea de Ibănești	Natural Cheese	6: Livestock Product
91	Slovenia	Kranjska klobasa	Sausage	6: Livestock Product
92	Spain	Estepa	Olive Oil	9: Oil and Fat Product

Japan's GI System and Reciprocal GI Designations

In 2015, the Act on Protection of the Names of Specific Agricultural, Forestry and Fishery Products and Foodstuffs ([GI Act](#)) established Japan's [GI system](#) for agricultural and food products ([JA5008](#)). Through

this system, domestic and foreign products are subject to a registration process that includes both a public comment period and a review by an expert committee. As of July 2020, MAFF has registered 96 GIs for agricultural, forestry, and fishery products through this system.¹

The GI Act was amended in 2016 to allow for reciprocal protection of products with GI designations in foreign countries. Unlike for domestically registered GI products, for products with reciprocal GI protection MAFF does not monitor compliance with product specifications for GI designations in their country of origin. Since February 1, 2019, MAFF has approved 71 reciprocal GI designations for agricultural and fisheries products from the EU ([JA7151](#)).

Japan's National Tax Agency (NTA) administers GI protections for alcoholic beverages. As of July 2020, the NTA has registered 12 domestic alcoholic beverages for GI protection. On February 1, 2019, the NTA designated 139 EU alcoholic beverages for GI protection ([JA8003](#)). The NTA also provides GI protection for seven other foreign alcoholic beverages, including products from Mexico (Tequila, Mezcal, Sotol, Bacanora, Charanda), Chile (Chilean Pisco), and Peru (Pisco Peru).

In 2018, Japan amended the GI Act to limit the continued use of a prior used term that has since become protected to a period of 7 years from the date of registration/designation of a GI ([JA8065](#)).

How to Submit Public Comments

Comments on the 21 newly proposed EU GI designations must be submitted using the [submission form](#), be submitted in Japanese, and be stamped with the submitter's seal or signed. Comments for the attention of MAFF should be submitted in-person, via mail, or via e-mail to MAFF by October 7, 2020. For more information: https://www.maff.go.jp/j/shokusan/gi_act/designation/index2.html

In-person or via mail:

Intellectual Property Division, Food Industry Affairs Bureau,
Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries
1-2-1 Kasumigaseki, Chiyoda-ku, Tokyo 100-8950, Japan

In-person comments will be accepted by MAFF at the above referenced address, from 10:00 to 12:00, and from 13:00 to 17:00 (except Saturdays, Sundays, and holidays).

Via e-mail:

gi-info@maff.go.jp.

It is needed to attach a digital scan of the submission form, stamped with the seal or signed.

Attachments:

No Attachments.

¹ Including Prosciutto di Parma, which completed the domestic GI registration process ([JA7118](#)).